



KAUST ACADEMY - Intro to Cybersecurity 2026

Metasploitable 2 on Apple Silicon

This is a guide on how to set up Metasploitable on M1/M2/M3 MacBooks. If you come across any difficulties during the set-up, please ask for help from the TAs or feel free to message me on [LinkedIn](#).

Requirements:

1. Metasploitable - You can download it from the drive we shared with you or alternatively [here](#).
2. UTM - A hypervisor to run the virtual machines. Click [here](#) to install.
3. Homebrew - A package manager for installing tools, programming languages, and other software.

Install Homebrew by running this command in your terminal:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

4. QEMU - An emulator that allows ARM processors to run x86 architecture software.

Install QEMU by running this command in your terminal:

```
brew install qemu
```

Let's start to set up!

1 - Navigate to the downloaded Metasploitable folder. If you haven't moved the file, you can run this command in your terminal:

```
cd Downloads/Metasploitable2-Linux
```

2 - The .vmdk file needs to be converted to .qcow2 format. We'll use QEMU for this conversion by running this command in your terminal:

```
qemu-img convert -p -O qcow2 Metasploitable.vmdk Metasploitable.qcow2
```

3 - After converting the file successfully, open UTM to set up the virtual machine. Follow these steps in UTM:

1. Create Virtual Machine
2. Custom: Emulate
3. Operating System: Other
4. Hardware: set memory to at least 2048 MiB and cores to at least 1, leave everything else as is.
5. Other: Boot Device: None, uncheck UEFI Boot.
6. Storage: set to 10GB, doesn't really matter.
7. Shared Directory: Continue
8. Summary: set 'Name' to Metasploitable-2

4 - Now that we have the VM set up, we need to make a few adjustments. Let's edit the VM:

1. Edit by double-clicking the vm → Edit
2. IDE Drive → Delete
3. New → Import → Metasploitable.qcow2 → Save

DONE!